



STAKEHOLDER BRIEFING · REVISED JULY 2026 (V3 SPLIT)

PolyWiz Paid Ads Engine

A new campaign *class* beside the organic engine —
conversion-oriented ads, multi-objective, configured per
brand

Pilot: open-call submissions

Multi-objective

Per-brand config

UPDATE · JULY 2026

We're building the creative half first

This plan now splits in two. The half that needs nothing from anyone — the creative engine — we build now. The half that needs new subscriptions and website changes, we hold.

BUILDING NOW · UNBLOCKED

Ad Creative Generator

Turns our own artworks, stories & photos into ad-ready images, carousels, and short caption videos. We download them and place the ads in Facebook/Instagram ourselves — the way we already do. No new subscription, no website changes, no ad spend to build it.

HELD FOR LATER · BLOCKED

Automated Ad Launch

One-click launch, automatic optimization & reporting. Needs the \$100/mo ad add-on, ad-account connections, and tracking pixels on 2 of 3 websites. Fully researched, parked until those are in place and it's worth it.

The rest of the deck is the *full* engine; the green card ships first. Two caveats: we stage ads by hand (no one-click launch yet), and it means *more, better creatives* — not automatic winner-picking.

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

This year's exhibition initiative — and the one gap in it

It keeps coming up in our weekly staff calls: we put **hundreds of hours** into curating open calls and exhibitions — but we don't really *promote* them. The work is strong; it just doesn't reach far enough.

THE FOCUS THIS YEAR

Get our exhibitions **seen** — especially the **partner shows** — and **lift open-call submission rates**.

Promotion is what makes the curation pay off.

TWO IDEAS BEHIND IT

011 — an owned promotion & PR engine.

007 — a paid-ads engine that drives submissions and exhibition reach. Developed together, meant to ship together.

WHERE THIS GOES

One engine, the whole content universe

We're building an **engine**, not a one-off campaign.

START HERE This year's **exhibitions & open calls** — the team's hard work, arguably the best content we have right now, finally getting the promotion it deserves.

THEN The same engine reaches everything **Arterial makes** — the Not Real Art and Artsville podcasts, Q+Art (Morgan's interview series), "Remote" (the public-art video series), and more across our brands.

IN THE FALL On the road to **fundraising** — once it's proven across the content universe, the same engine powers the fall fundraising push too.

We don't launch all of this at once. We build the engine once, then point it — one focused step at a time. First: this year's exhibitions.

THE CORE IDEA

Ads are a different animal — a new campaign *class*

PolyWiz today is an **organic trickling engine** — a URL becomes a six-month tapering series of posts. A paid ad campaign is a fundamentally different object. We add it **beside** the organic engine, not inside it.

ORGANIC CAMPAIGN · EXISTS TODAY

Unit — 6-month series of dozens of posts

Lifecycle — tapering schedule → publish → done

Goal — reach, cadence, presence

Optimizer — our distribution-bias schedule

Metric — posts shipped, reach

PAID AD CAMPAIGN · THIS IDEA

Unit — 1–few ads × many **variations**, tested at once

Lifecycle — budgeted flight → learning → kill / scale

Goal — **conversion** — submit, register, subscribe, donate

Optimizer — the ad platform's algorithm

Metric — **cost per action**

Forcing this into "just another organic campaign type" would bury a budget-driven, conversion-optimized object inside a generator built for cadence. **Two sibling classes instead.**

WHAT'S SHARED, WHAT DIVERGES

One intake. Two engines.

Both classes start **identically** — paste a URL, scrape it, pull brand voice and visuals. That overlap is real and worth reusing. After intake they diverge completely.

SHARED INTAKE SUBSTRATE · ALREADY BUILT

URL → Firecrawl scrape → brand voice → image catalog → auto-crop → creative gen

↓ ORGANIC DIVERGES TO

A tapering post-series on a cadence schedule.

↓ PAID DIVERGES TO

Ads × variations on a budgeted flight — with an **objective, investment level, platform mix, flight length, ad account, audience, and landing page** — and an optimization loop that kills losers and scales winners.

LAYER 2 — THE OBJECTIVES

One engine, many conversion objectives

Within a paid campaign, the **objective** is the conversion dimension. Each sets the platform goal, the conversion event, the creative angles, the platform mix, the pacing, and the KPI.

Open-call submissions · pilot	Submit / Lead	deadline · prize · eligibility	Meta + Pinterest + Google Ad Grants · deadline flight
Exhibition interest	View → Subscribe	visual hero · artist spotlight	Pinterest + IG + Meta · run-of-show
Newsletter growth	Subscribe	value-of-issue · FOMO	Meta + newsletter ad networks · always-on
Event / workshop · occasional	RSVP / Register	date · lineup · local	Meta + Nextdoor (local) · date flight
Fundraising / donations	Donate / Pledge	impact · matching-gift · partnership	Meta + Google Ad Grants + email · seasonal

Fundraising is in the vision from day one — built last. It's the highest-interest objective and a 501(c)(3) governance asset (the "broad support from 500+ donors" public-support test). But donation conversion is the hardest to build, so we prove the engine on the easy, measurable objectives first.

LAYER 3 — PER-BRAND CONFIGURATION

Which objectives a brand can run is a brand setting

Not every objective applies to every brand — fundraising is irrelevant to a for-profit; The Intersect may only ever grow its list. Same gating PolyWiz already uses for per-brand feature flags, extended to **enabled objectives + connected ad accounts + budget envelope** per brand.

	OPEN CALLS	EXHIBITIONS	NEWSLETTER	EVENTS	FUNDRAISING
Not Real Art	✓	✓	✓	occasional	✓ last
Artsville USA	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓ last
The Intersect	—	—	✓	—	—

Every brand sees only the objectives it's configured for. **One engine, per-brand capability surface** — illustrative; final values are a config decision.

A DESIGN QUESTION WORTH CALLING OUT

Exhibition interest is a *dual* objective — a newsletter feeder

THE PROBLEM

A bare "they viewed the exhibition" is a weak success signal. Looking isn't interest. Optimizing only for views buys traffic we can't follow up with.



THE DESIGN

Optimize for the *view* as the platform conversion *and* layer a *secondary capture* on the landing page — prompt the engaged visitor to *subscribe, follow the exhibition, or follow the brand* via scroll-depth / time-on-page / exit-intent CTAs.

The compounding loop. A paid exhibition flight produces views now, captured subscribers/followers from the interested minority, and a retargeting pool that makes the *next* campaign cheaper. The same secondary-capture pattern applies to open calls (non-submitters → newsletter) and, later, fundraising (interested non-donors → cultivation list). Idea 011 names this loop.

WHAT WE ALREADY HAVE VS. WHAT'S NEW

The build is mostly extension, not invention

SHARED SUBSTRATE · ALREADY BUILT

- ✓ Start-from-URL → Firecrawl scrape
- ✓ Brand voice + tone
- ✓ Multi-platform copy generation (Claude)
- ✓ Image catalog from scraped URLs
- ✓ Auto-crop to platform aspect ratios
- ✓ Vercel Blob image hosting
- ✓ Per-brand keys + feature flags
- ✓ Zernio integration (organic + now ads)

NEW — CREATIVE NOW, LAUNCH LATER

- + Ad Creative Generator — copy + layout variants · now
- + Static + carousel ad layouts · now
- + “Ken Burns” caption video (Remotion) · now
- + Export package for manual FB/IG staging · now
- + Zernio Ads launch via SDK · later
- + Ad-account OAuth + pixels / CAPI · later
- + Event-driven lead capture · later
- + Variant rotation (kill / scale) · later

The creative engine is the moat — and the unblocked half we build first (real assets first; AI imagery optional).
The launch object, its config, and the optimization loop come later.

THE LATER HALF · AUTOMATED LAUNCH

When we automate launch, it runs through the same tool

This slide describes the deferred half. *Today we stage the generated creatives in Facebook/Instagram by hand.* When we later automate that, paid ads go out through **Zernio** — the exact same service the brands already use for organic posts: nothing new to learn, no second vendor. Turning it on is a single flat **\$100/mo** add-on to that existing subscription — one shared cost across every brand and objective.

ONE TOOL · SIX PAID NETWORKS

Meta — Facebook + Instagram

Pinterest

Google

LinkedIn

TikTok

X

SAME TOOL

Already in use for organic posting. Paid ads are turned on inside it — no migration, no new system.

EACH BRAND STAYS SEPARATE

Every brand connects its own ad account, so budgets and reporting never cross between brands.

PHASE PLAN

Build order — creative generator first, launch later, fundraising last

- **Now — Ad Creative Generator** in retainer · unblocked
Studio on the campaign page: pick real assets, generate copy + static / carousel / “Ken Burns” video variants, export a package. Staged in FB/IG by hand — no add-on, no pixels, no spend.
- **Then — More objectives + video polish** still export-for-manual
Extend the generator across objectives (open call, exhibition, newsletter) and refine the Ken Burns builder. Output is still a downloadable pack we place ourselves.
- **Later (deferred) — Launch prerequisites** blocked until funded
\$100/mo Zernio ads add-on, per-brand ad-account OAuth, and Pixel + Conversions API on the brand sites that lack them. None of this is needed for the creative generator above.
- **Later — Automated launch + optimization** once prerequisites land
One-click launch through Zernio, event-driven lead capture, variant rotation (kill / scale), and a cost-per-action dashboard. The open-call pilot flight runs here.
- **Vision — Fundraising, last** built last, in view from day one
Donation objective with value-based optimization + donor compliance; Google Ad Grants for nonprofit search. Plus lookalikes, cross-brand reporting, auto-pacing.

WHAT THE LAUNCH HALF NEEDS

Three prerequisites — deferred, not on the critical path

The Ad Creative Generator needs none of these — it ships now. These clear only when we choose to automate launch.

1

\$100/mo ads add-on

A flat monthly subscription on the existing Zernio account. **One shared cost** across every brand and objective — not per brand, and separate from per-flight ad spend.

2

Connect per-brand ad accounts

Each brand's Meta / Pinterest ad account via Zernio OAuth (`/v1/connect/{platform}/ads`). Budget authority decided per brand.

3

Pixel + Conversions API

Server-side CAP lifts conversion capture from 70–80% to 90–95%. Artsville needs the Pixel; Intersect-on-Curated needs CAPI.

All three are **solvable in days** — but they precede **automated launch**, which is deferred. The pilot flight can also be staged by hand once the creatives exist.

THE DECISION, SPLIT IN TWO

Now: build the creatives. Later: green-light the paid flight.

BUILDING NOW · \$0 NEW

Ad Creative Generator

In the existing Polymash retainer — no new line item. Produces ad-ready creatives we stage in FB/IG by hand.

LATER · TO GO PAID

**\$100/mo +
~\$250**

The Zernio ads add-on plus a deadline-timed open-call flight — when we choose to spend. Can be staged by hand before any launch automation.

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

**Cost /
submission**

Our **first-ever clean reading** — measured when we run the paid flight. That number unlocks every other brand and objective.

What's already covered: the build is baked into the existing Polymash retainer — **no new line item**. The creative generator needs no new money at all; the only new spend is the add-on + ad flight, and only when we go paid.

The **creatives come first** — unblocked, in retainer. The **paid flight is the next green-light**, on the road to promoting the whole content universe and, in time, fundraising.



First: build the ad creatives

The creative generator ships now — [epic #372](#). Launch automation is fully scoped and deferred — [#181](#). 007 + 011 still ship together.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

Sources & References

All research lives in [ideas/007-polywiz-paid-ads-engine/research/](#) — phase sub-issues, plus [sources.md](#) with every URL, quote, retrieval date, and defensibility note.

Zernio Ads add-on = \$100/mo on our AppSumo account — Zernio in-product paywall, confirmed 2026-06-18 (not bundled for legacy/AppSumo plans; flat monthly fee, separate from ad spend)

Andromeda rewards creative volume + diversity — [Meta Engineering, Dec 2024](#)

Pinterest CPC 30–50% cheaper than Meta; 619M MAU — [WebFX 2026](#) · [Pinterest Q4 2025](#)

Google Ad Grants — \$10k/mo free for 501(c)(3)s — [Google for Nonprofits](#) · captured in idea 011's master resource

Zernio Ads API re-verified — 6 networks, ad webhooks, SDK 0.2.101 ads namespaces — [Zernio OpenAPI v1.0.4, retrieved 2026-06-18](#)

17.8% lower cost-per-result with CAPI — [Meta announcement, Apr 2026](#)

Detailed interest targeting deprecated Jan 2026 — [Meta Help Center via Brandwatch](#)

Plus first-party data (\$0.80–\$0.90 historical CPA on \$70K/yr Meta budgets; brand pixel status; 011's open-call landing-page campaign evidence) — logged in [research/sources.md](#)